CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

HANDYMAN COMPANY OWNER IN THE AI ERA

AI can diagnose a wobbly toilet from a photo. It still can't show up with a wrench.

★ TL;DR — Owners land around ~$75K on the site's scale, startable in 1–6 months with no license for small jobs. The catch: the line between handyman work and licensed trade work is exactly where beginners get fined. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

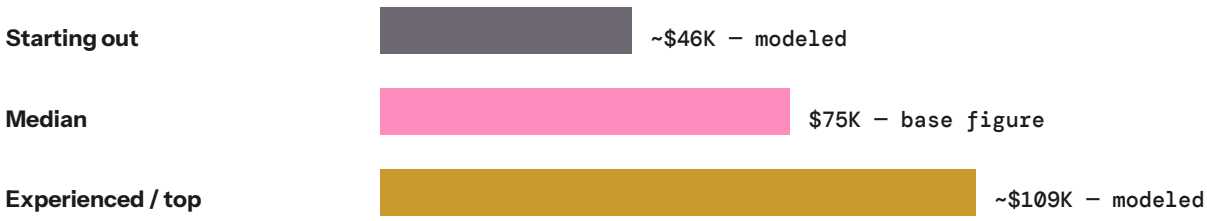
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Every homeowner has a list; almost none have the time or the tools.
- A small-job focus keeps you outside licensed-trade territory in most states — know your local scope and limits.
- Software books and invoices; trust and fix-it judgment are the moat.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Handyman Company Owner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A HANDYMAN COMPANY OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Run a daily list: mounts, patches, fixtures, doors, caulk, paint touch-ups
- ✓ Estimate small jobs on the spot and price the next visit

✓ Buy materials and manage a van full of tools

✓ Follow up, invoice and collect reviews

Think: a primary-care doctor for houses — many small problems, fixed the same day.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Booking platforms, AI receptionists and photo-quote tools handle intake and scheduling. Video diagnostics help you arrive with the right parts.	Diagnosing the weird rattle in person, improvising a fix for a 40-year-old house, and being trusted alone in someone's home — that's the job.

⚠ **Scope creep into plumbing, electrical or structural work without the required license is the classic beginner fine — and insurance won't save you.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Variety: no two days or houses alike ✓ Premium rates for the small jobs pros won't take ✓ Referrals from realtors and property managers compound	✗ You're the product until you hire — sick days pay zero ✗ Chasing payment on small invoices is a weekly sport ✗ Tool and material runs eat unpaid hours

Good fit? Broadly handy, honest about your limits, and good with homeowners.
Bad fit? You can't resist taking jobs beyond your skill and legal scope.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — WORK FOR A HANDYMAN OR REMODEL CREW	DOOR B — START WITH YOUR OWN LIST
A season with an established handyman service or remodeler teaches pricing, pace and which jobs lose money. Then launch with a real rate card instead of guesses.	Register, insure, set a minimum visit price, and start with neighbors, realtors and property managers. Sell punch-list days to landlords and home sellers — steady, pre-sold work.

Smart move: Publish a minimum charge and a fixed menu of flat-rate small jobs — it kills haggling and fills the day profitably.
Where you land after: Booked solo operator → second van and technician → you estimate and manage.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
DEFINE YOUR	SET UP	BUILD THE	FIND ANCHOR	RUN TIGHT	HIRE AND

STEP 1 — Define your legal menu

FREE · TODAY

- List the jobs you'll take and the jobs you'll refuse (licensed trades, structural).
- Check your state's handyman scope and job-value limits.

STEP 2 — Set up the business

WEEKS

- Register, get liability insurance, set up invoicing and a booking page.
- A minimum service charge from day one — no free quick looks.

STEP 3 — Build the rate card

MONTHS 1-2

- Flat prices for common tasks; hourly with a minimum for the rest.
- Photograph every finished job for your portfolio.

STEP 4 — Find anchor clients

MARKETING

- Realtors (pre-sale punch lists), landlords and property managers first.
- Homeowner groups and neighborhood referrals second.

STEP 5 — Run tight days

DAILY

- Batch jobs by neighborhood; confirm materials before you roll.
- Invoice on site, ask for the review on site.

STEP 6 — Hire and step back

WHEN BOOKED OUT

- Add a technician for the simple list; you keep estimates and quality.
- Raise the minimum as demand grows — scarcity is pricing power.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: write your job menu, your refusals list and your minimum charge.
- Days 1–30: business and insurance live; first jobs from your own network.
- Days 31–60: weekly realtor and landlord outreach; rate card tested on real jobs.
- Days 61–90: repeat clients appearing; calendar booked a week out.
- Day 90: a functioning handyman business with anchors — growth is hiring and pricing now.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ SMALL JOBS. DONE RIGHT. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.